

New Ground: A Better Question

新的起点：更好的问题

Theme: 大学生生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The better question arrived in the evening, on the back of a **report**. Which item on the list actually changes a decision? The number of complaints was a **score**; the quality of one private note was a **factor**. “A city is not a **unit**,” Maya said. “It is a **league** of small arrangements.” Her hand moved across the page and stopped at a **single** line.

The club had spread its **stuff** across the table: a map, a **gas** bill, a **cover** from an old magazine, and a photograph of a **soldier**. The group had no **property**, no **estate**, and no **independent** income. Their **pride** was the only capital they had. “Where is the **conflict**?” Lin asked. “It is in the **distance** between what we measure and what people need.”

Mark the limit, then **adjust the shape**. A **voluntary member** of the committee, a **captain** of the rowing team, and a student who studied **philosophy** all said the same thing: the **decline** of trust had a **consequence** that no chart showed. The old **colonial** map was still on the wall under a **protective** sheet of plastic. **Restraint**, not enthusiasm, would decide whether they could keep their idea alive.

The **climax** came on a Thursday, when the student union demanded a decision. Lin wanted to **clone the** successful west-gate experiment; Maya wanted to keep the club's independence. “That is not a choice,” she said. “That is a **descent** into the same mistake.” Anything else, she thought, would be **pride** wearing a new coat.

They chose a third path. The **report** would change one line: from “**cover** every gate” to “ask a better question at every gate.” But the rate of progress was slower than anyone liked, and no one could explain why. A **guy** from the **city** desk laughed at their **absolute** rule, and then wrote it down. “Your notes are the only thing holding this together,” Lin said. “Each **member** has to **share** them, and that is an opportunity, not a burden.” Until the summer, a **voluntary** team would keep the notes public; after that, the **arrangement** would have to stand on its own. “Yeah,” Maya said, “that is worth the risk.”

中文翻译

更好的问题在傍晚到来，写在一份报告的背面。清单上哪一项真正改变决定？抱怨的数量只是一个分数；一条私人笔记的品质才是一个因子。“城市不是一个单位，”曼雅说，“它是许多小安排的联盟。”她的手在纸面上移动，停在单独一行上。

社团的东西摊了一桌：一张地图、一张燃气账单、一本旧杂志的封面，还有一张士兵的照片。小组没有财产、没有地产，也没有独立收入。他们的自尊是唯一的资本。“冲突在哪里？”林伟问。“它就在我们所测量的和人们所需要的之间的距离里。”

标出界限，然后调整形状。委员会里一位自愿参加的成员、赛艇队的队长，以及一名学哲学的学生都说了同一件事：信任的衰退有一个任何图表都显示不出的后果。那张旧的殖民地地图还挂在墙上，盖着一层保护性的塑料膜。决定他们能否让想法活下来的是克制，而不是热情。

高潮在周四到来，学生会要求他们做出决定。林伟想复制西门的成功实验；曼雅想保住社团的独立性。“这不是选择，”她说，“这是坠入同一个错误。”她心想，其他任何做法都只是披着新外套的自尊。

他们选了第三条路。报告只改一行：从“覆盖每一道门”改成“在每一道门前问一个更好的问题”。但进展的速度比任何人希望的都慢，也没人说得清为什么。城市版的一位家伙嘲笑他们那条绝对规则，随后又把它记了下来。“你的笔记是唯一撑住这一切的东西，”林伟说，“每个成员都必须共享它们，而这是一个机会，不是负担。”在夏天之前，一支自愿的团队会让笔记保持公开；之后，这套安排必须自己站得住。“是的，”曼雅说，“这值得冒险。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
the ðə POS: art	art. 那 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. i. See Thee.; definite article. A word placed before nouns to limit or; individualize their meaning.; adv. ...
which hwɪtʃ POS: pron	pron. 哪一个, 那一个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. Of what sort or kind; what; what a; who.; a. A interrogative pronoun, used both substantively and; adj. ...
her he: POS: pron	pron. 她的, 她 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. & a. The form of the objective and the possessive case of; the personal pronoun she; as, I saw her wi...
number ˈnʌmbə POS: n	n. 数, 数字, 数目, 号码; vt. 数, 计算, 共计; vi. 计算, 报数; [计] 数字 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property possessed by a sum or total or indefinite quantity of units or individuals; n. a concept of qu...
member ˈmembə POS: n	n. 成员, 会员; [医] 肢, 肢体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the persons who compose a social group (especially individuals who have joined and participate in a...
report rɪˈpɔ:t POS: n	n. 报告, 报道, 传说, 案情报告, 爆炸声, 成绩单; vt. 报告, 汇报, 转述, 报道, 揭发, 使报到; vi. 报告, 写报道... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written document describing the findings of some individual or group; n. the act of informing by verbal r...
city ˈsɪti POS: n	n. 城市, 市; [法] 都市, 城市, 市 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large and densely populated urban area; may include several independent administrative districts; n. an i...
guy ɡaɪ POS: n	n. 家伙, 支索; vt. 用支索撑住, 取笑, 嘲弄; vi. 逃跑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an informal term for a youth or man; n. an effigy of Guy Fawkes that is burned on a bonfire on Guy Fawkes D...
cover ˈkʌvə POS: n	n. 盖子, 封面, 藉口; vt. 覆盖, 掩饰, 保护, 掩护, 包括; vi. 覆盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of concealing the existence of something by obstructing the view of it; n. fire that makes it diffi...
quality ˈkwɒləti POS: n	n. 品质, 特性, 才能, 质量; a. 优质的; [计] 品质 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an essential and distinguishing attribute of something or someone; n. a degree or grade of excellence or wo...
unit ˈju:nɪt POS: n	n. 单位, 分队, 部队, 单元, 部件, 装置; a. 单位的, 单元的; [计] 单元常数; 部件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an individual or group or structure or other entity regarded as a structural or functional constituent of...
single ˈsɪŋɡl POS: a	a. 单身的, 单程的, 单一的, 个别的, 孤独的, 专一的; n. 一个, 单打, 单程票; vt. 选出; vi. 击出一垒打; [计] 单... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a base hit on which the batter stops safely at first base; v. hit a single; a. used of flowers having usuall...
private ˈpraɪvɪt POS: a	a. 私人的, 秘密的, 私立的, 隐蔽的; n. 士兵, 隐士, 阴部; [计] 私人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an enlisted man of the lowest rank in the Army or Marines; a. confined to particular persons or groups or p...
property ˈprɒpəti POS: n	n. 财产, 所有权, 性质, 属性; [计] 属性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something owned; any tangible or intangible possession that is owned by someone; ; n. a basic or essential...
share ʃeə POS: n	n. 部分, 参与, 一份, 参股, 份额; vt. 均分, 分担, 分享, 分配, 共有; vi. 分享; [计] 共享; DOS外部命令:在... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. assets belonging to or due to or contributed by an individual person or group; n. any of the equal portions...
factor ˈfæktə POS: n	n. 因素, 因数, 系数, 基因, 代理人; [计] 因式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. anything that contributes causally to a result; n. any of the numbers (or symbols) that form a product when...
note nəʊt POS: n	n. 笔记, 记录, 注解, 票据, 符号, 显要, 注重, 便笺, 照会; vt. 记录, 注解, 注意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a brief written record; n. a short personal letter; n. a notation representing the pitch and duration of a m...
item ˈaɪtəm POS: n	n. 项目, 条款, 一则, 项; [计] 项 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a distinct part that can be specified separately in a group of things that could be enumerated on a list; n...
stuff stʌf POS: n	n. 原料, 要素, 东西, 材料, 素质, 织品, 废物, 废话; vt. 装填; vi. 狼吞虎咽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. miscellaneous unspecified objects; n. informal terms for personal possessions; n. senseless talk; n. unspecif...

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soldier 'səʊldʒə POS: n	n. 军人, 士兵, 兵蚁; vi. 从军, 尽职, 偷懒, 磨洋工 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an enlisted man or woman who serves in an army; n. a wingless sterile ant or termite having a large head an...
independent 'ɪndɪ'pendənt POS: n	n. 独立自主者, 无党派者; a. 独立的, 有主见的, 不须依赖的, 不受约束的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. free from external control and constraint; a. (of a clause) capable of standing syntactically alone as a co...
gas gæs POS: n	n. 气体, 汽油, 瓦斯; [化] 气体; 煤气; 瓦斯; 毒气 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of matter distinguished from the solid and liquid states by: relatively low density and viscosit...
score skɔː POS: n	n. 得分, 抓痕, 二十个, 刻痕, 帐目, 乐谱, 起跑线, 终点线, 大量; vt. 刻划, 划线, 获得, 评价, 把...记下; v... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written form of a musical composition; parts for different instruments appear on separate staves on larg...
arrangement ə'reɪndʒmənt POS: n	n. 排列, 整齐, 安排; [计] 排列 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an orderly grouping (of things or persons) considered as a unit; the result of arranging; n. an organized s...
conflict 'kɒnflɪkt POS: n	n. 战斗, 冲突, 矛盾, 争执; vi. 争执, 战斗, 冲突, 抵触; [计] 冲突 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an open clash between two opposing groups (or individuals); n. opposition between two simultaneous but inco...
league li:g POS: n	n. 同盟, 联盟, 盟约; v. 组联盟, (使)加盟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an association of sports teams that organizes matches for its members; n. an association of states or organ...
shape ʃeɪp POS: n	n. 形状, 形态, 外形, 形式, 身材; vt. 定形, 使成形, 塑造, 计划, 使符合; vi. 成形, 形成, 成长; [计] 形状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any spatial attributes (especially as defined by outline); n. the spatial arrangement of something as disti...
consequence 'kɒnsɪkwəns POS: n	n. 结果, 重要性; [法] 结果, 后果, 推断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a phenomenon that follows and is caused by some previous phenomenon; n. the outcome of an event especially...
distance 'dɪstəns POS: n	n. 距离, 远方, 遥远; [计] 位距 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property created by the space between two objects or points; n. a distant region; n. size of the gap bet...
mark mɑ:k POS: n	n. 标志, 分数, 马克, 痕迹, 斑点, 靶子, 刻度, 记号, 符号, 戳记, 标准, 起跑线; vt. 做标记于, 留意, 打分数, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a number or letter indicating quality (especially of a student's performance); n. a visible indication made...
estate 'i:steɪt POS: n	n. 不动产, (人生的)阶段, 阶层, 财产; [经] 房地产, 遗产, 财产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. everything you own; all of your assets (whether real property or personal property) and liabilities; n. ext...
limit 'lɪmɪt POS: n	n. 界限, 边界, 限度, 极限, 限制; vt. 限制, 限定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the greatest possible degree of something; n. as far as something can go; n. the boundary of a specific area...
captain 'kæptɪn POS: n	n. 船长, 指挥官, 海军上校, 首领; vt. 率领, 指挥 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an officer holding a rank below a major but above a lieutenant; n. the naval officer in command of a milita...
decline dɪ'klaɪn POS: n	n. 衰退, 跌落, 下降; vt. 使降低, 婉谢; vi. 下降, 衰落, 偏斜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. change toward something smaller or lower; n. a condition inferior to an earlier condition; a gradual fallin...
philosophy fɪ'lɒsəfi POS: n	n. 哲学, 人生观, 哲学思想, 哲理, 基本原理, 见解, 达观, 沉着 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the rational investigation of questions about existence and knowledge and ethics; n. any personal belief ab...
voluntary 'vɒləntəri POS: a	a. 自动的, 自愿的, 故意的, 志愿的, 自发的; n. 自愿行动, 志愿者, 自由调 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. composition (often improvised) for a solo instrument (especially solo organ) and not a regular part of a r...
adjust ə'dʒʌst POS: vt	vt. 调整, 使适应于, 校准; vi. 适应于, 被调节, 相互熟悉而适应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. alter or regulate so as to achieve accuracy or conform to a standard; v. adapt or conform oneself to new or...
absolute 'æbsəlu:t POS: a	a. 绝对的, 专制的, 完全的, 独立的; n. 绝对事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that is conceived or that exists independently and not in relation to other things; something th...
pride praɪd POS: n	n. 骄傲, 自尊心, 自豪, 精华, 勇气; vt. 以...自豪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of self-respect and personal worth; n. satisfaction with your (or another's) achievements; n. the...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
colonial kə'leɪnjəl POS: a	a. 殖民的, 殖民地的; [法] 殖民地居民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a resident of a colony; a. of or relating to or characteristic of or inhabiting a colony; a. of animals who...
protective prə'tektɪv POS: a	a. 给予保护的, 保护的; [医] 保护的, 防护的, 保护剂, 保护物, 油绸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. intended or adapted to afford protection of some kind; s. showing care; s. (usually followed by 'of') soliciti...
restraint rɪ'streɪnt POS: n	n. 抑制, 克制, 束缚; [医] 约束, 拘束 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of controlling by restraining someone or something; n. discipline in personal and social activities...
descent dɪ'sent POS: n	n. 降落, 家系, 侵袭, 血统; [医] 下降, 世代, 血统 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a movement downward; n. the act of changing your location in a downward direction; n. the kinship relation b...
climax 'klaɪmæks POS: n	n. 高潮, 极点, 层进法; v. (使)达到顶点, (使)达到高潮 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the highest point of anything conceived of as growing or developing or unfolding; n. the decisive moment in...
clone kləʊn POS: n	n. 无性系; [计] 代用件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of genetically identical cells or organisms derived from a single cell or individual by some kind...